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# Universal Credit

Contents

— What Universal Credit is

— Eligibility (/universal-credit/eligibility)

— What you'll get (/universal-credit/what-youll-get)

— How your wages affect your payments (/universal-credit/how-your-wages-affect-your-payments)

— How you're paid (/universal-credit/how-youre-paid)

— How to claim (/universal-credit/how-to-claim)

— Your claimant commitment (/universal-credit/your-claimant-commitment)

— Get an advance or other financial support (/universal-credit/get-advance-or-financial-support)

— Report a change of circumstances (/universal-credit/changes-of-circumstances)

— Contact Universal Credit (/universal-credit/contact-universal-credit)

# What Universal Credit is

Universal Credit is a payment to help with your living costs. It’s paid monthly - or twice a month for some people in Scotland (/universal-credit/how-youre-paid).

You may be able to get it if you’re on a low income, out of work or you cannot work.

> This guide is also available in Welsh (Cymraeg) (/credyd-cynhwysol) and in an easy read format (/government/publications/easy-read-universal-credit).

If you live in Northern Ireland, go to Universal Credit in Northern Ireland (https://www.nidirect.gov.uk/universal-credit).

## Sign in

Sign in to your Universal Credit account (/sign-in-universal-credit) if you already have one.

## If you already get other benefits

Universal Credit is replacing the following benefits:

- Housing Benefit
- Income Support
- income-based Jobseeker's Allowance (JSA)
- income-related Employment and Support Allowance (ESA)

If you're getting any of these benefits, you do not need to do anything unless either:

- your circumstances change
- you get a letter called a 'Migration Notice' telling you that you must claim Universal Credit

> If you get a Migration Notice, you must move to Universal Credit (/guidance/move-to-universal-credit-if-you-get-a-migration-notice-letter) by the deadline date in your letter to keep getting financial support.

You'll stop getting these benefits when you or your partner claim Universal Credit. If you or your partner gets Pension Credit, this will also stop if one of you claims Universal Credit.

You'll continue getting any other benefits you already receive, such as Personal Independence Payment (PIP) or Carer's Allowance.

If you get certain other benefits at the same time as Universal Credit (/universal-credit/what-youll-get), the amount of Universal Credit you receive will be reduced.

→ **Next**
Eligibility **(/universal-credit/eligibility)**

View a printable version of the whole guide (/universal-credit/print)

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